

Spoken Tutorial on API

Module	An Introduction to Building with AI
Episode	3. Understanding APIs
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is. 2. Explain the role of an API key. 3. Identify the components of an API request.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• API Analogy: Restaurant Waiter • API Key • API Request
Meta Tags	API, API Key, API Request, AI, Application Programming Interface, Prompting, Development, AI Essentials, Messaging, Authentication
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Module 2: Art of the Prompt

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Title Slide	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on API .
Learning Objectives Slide	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an API is. • Explain the role of an API key. • Identify the components of an API request.
System Requirements Slide	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisite Slide	To follow this tutorial, you should have completed Module 2: Art of the Prompt .
Illustration of a restaurant waiter connecting a customer (application) to a kitchen (model).	What is an API ? An API , or Application Programming Interface , acts as a messenger. It connects your application to a model. Imagine an API as a restaurant waiter. You give your order, a request, to the waiter. The waiter takes it to the kitchen, the model. Then, the waiter brings your dish, the response, back to you. This is how an API helps applications communicate.

Illustration of an ID card or a secret key for authentication.	But how does the API know who you are? This is where an API key helps. An API key is a unique, secret password. It identifies you as an authorized user. Think of it like an ID card at a restaurant. It proves you are allowed to place an order. This key ensures only authorized users access the service.
Person at laptop, showing elements of an API request with an API key and a prompt.	With an API and an API key, you can make a request. An API request is how you talk to the AI model. It's like telling the chef exactly what you want. Your request always includes your API key. This key authenticates you as an authorized user. Then, you add your specific prompt or instruction. For example, 'Write a poem about a cat'. The API delivers this entire request to the model. The model processes it and gives you a response.
Summary Slide	Let us summarize what we learned. We defined APIs as messengers between applications and models. We understood API keys are for identification and authentication. Finally, we explored API requests as the way to interact with AI models.
Assignment Slide	Now as an assignment, Identify daily applications that use APIs. Think about how they send and receive information. Compare the results.
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